

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; kidney test

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. Kidney is proposed only in its literal sense.

B. Use in sequences

Two short combinations express established phrases:

- Kidney + rock: kidney stone.
- Kidney + test tube: kidney tests or kidney function tests.

MedlinePlus uses kidney stone analysis for a patient collecting a passed stone for a provider or laboratory, and lists kidney tests, kidney function tests, and kidney panel as established names for blood, urine, and imaging checks. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#) and [Kidney Tests](#).

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. The [current Unicode Emoji List](#) has no Kidney character. Beans is the closest encoded pictograph, and Unicode even includes kidney among its search keywords; however, its CLDR name is beans and it remains a Food & Drink pictograph. Generic medical emoji add care or testing but do not supply the missing literal organ. See the [Unicode Emoji List](#).

D. Distinctiveness

Kidney is shown as two maroon, inward-facing forms with visible medial notches, a slight vertical offset, and a short central attachment. At 18 pixels, the opposed notches and offset distinguish it from separate Beans and from the symmetric lobes and top-entering airway of Lungs. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomical detail while keeping the paired notched forms, offset, and short central attachment.

E. Expected usage level

Kidney names the organ in several distinct, established messages. MedlinePlus uses kidney stone, kidney stone analysis, kidney tests, kidney function tests, and kidney panel. NIDDK tells a patient to tell a doctor or nurse they want a kidney transplant and describes donor testing, waiting, surgery, and follow-up. HRSA uses donate a kidney, living donor, and kidney paired donation in guidance for recipients, donors, families, and transplant programs. NIDDK also explains dialysis through the work normally done by healthy kidneys. These uses are documented in [Kidney Stone Analysis](#), [Kidney Tests](#), [Kidney Transplant](#), [Living Donation](#), and [Hemodialysis](#). The same language is used outside the United States: NHS Blood and Transplant describes kidney transplant tests and explains dialysis when kidneys cannot filter the body normally. See [Kidney Transplant Tests](#) and [Dialysis](#).

The five required frequency exhibits below test the unfiltered term kidney; Google Trends and Google Books compare it with elephant. They establish sustained term visibility, not medical importance or guaranteed emoji use.

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Web Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 211,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Search query.](#)

3 of 8

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Video Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 66,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Video Search query.](#)

Google

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www.youtube.com › watch

How Do Kidneys Work?

For more information about the function of kidneys, please see <https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3> Your kidneys are your body's cle...
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch

Get to Know Your Kidneys

Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ...
YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch

Kidney Function

KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ...
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025

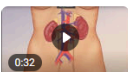
www.youtube.com › watch

How Your Kidneys Work

MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall.
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024

www.mayoclinic.org › multimedia › vid-20207497

How kidneys work

How kidneys work — Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine.
Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021

www.youtube.com › watch

Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease

Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ...
YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021

Any duration

Any time

Any quality

All videos

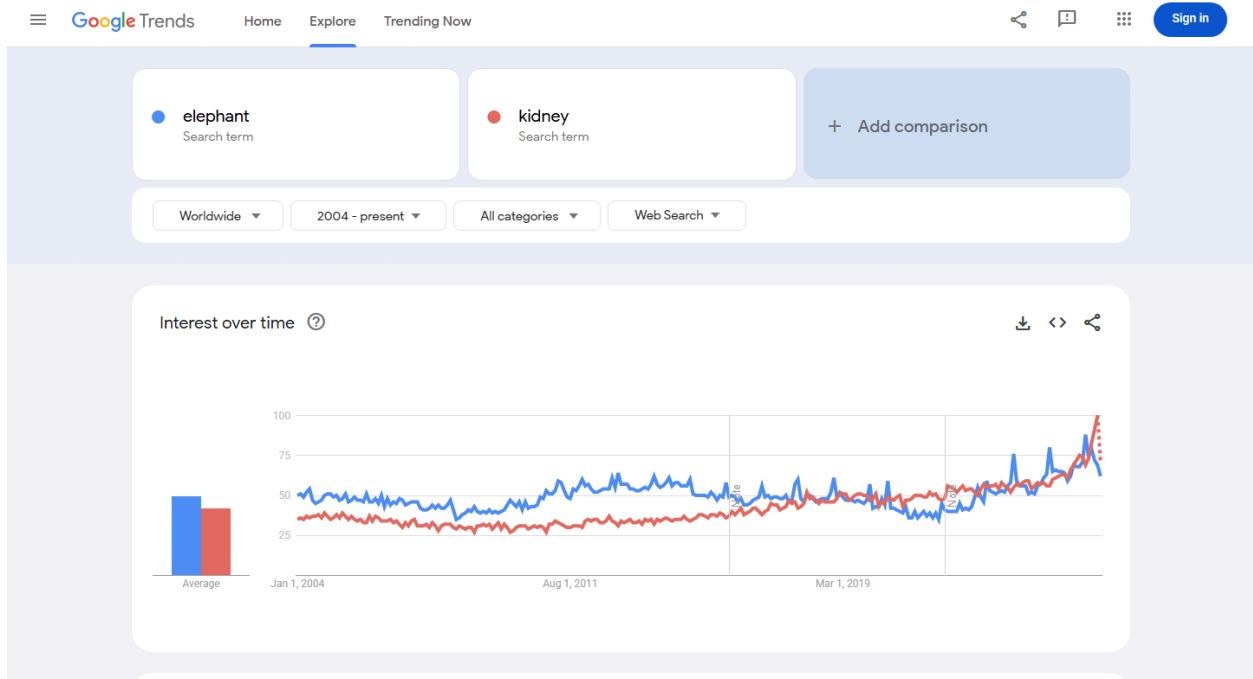
Any source

Advanced Search

About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)

Google Trends - Web Search

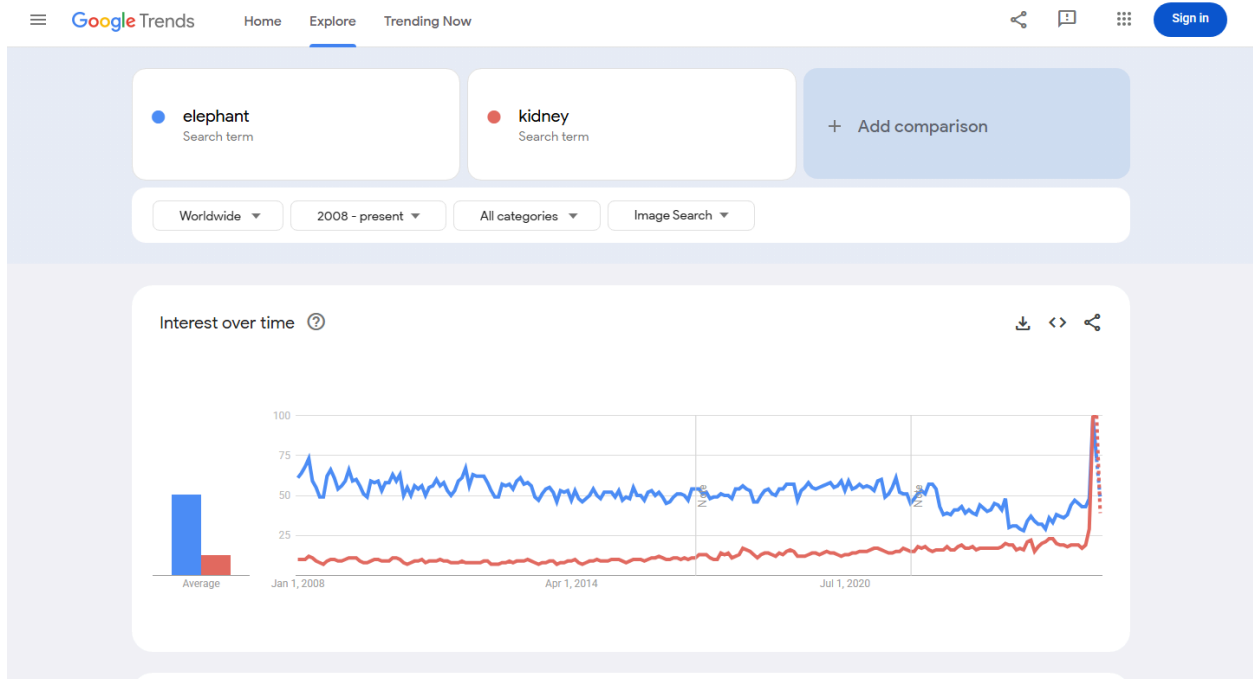
Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Elephant has the higher historical average; kidney remains sustained and reaches comparable or greater interest in recent periods. [Open the reproducible Google Trends Web Search query.](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Kidney shows sustained image-search interest but remains below elephant for most of the displayed range.

[Open the reproducible Google Trends Image Search query.](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query.](#)



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Internal organs are not a fixed set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Beans is the strongest existing single emoji. Unicode's own `kidney` keyword makes it searchable, and with shared context it can stand in for a kidney. Its visible and named meaning is still food. Beans + Hospital can suggest kidney care, but can equally read as food, diet, or beans at a hospital. Beans + Rock does not clearly name `kidney stone`, and Beans + Test Tube does not clearly name `kidney tests`; the reader must first assume that Beans means an organ. A Kidney character supplies that missing noun. See the [Unicode Emoji List](#).

B. Overly specific

Kidney represents the organ generally. The same noun is used in kidney stone analysis, kidney testing, dialysis, transplantation, and living donation; it is not a specific disease, procedure, campaign, organization, or subtype.

C. Open-ended

The closest unencoded neighbors are Liver, Stomach, Pancreas, and Spleen. Kidney has a specific combination that those names cannot simply reuse: kidney stone and dialysis, together with kidney testing and donation/transplant language. Beans and short sequences still fail to identify the organ, the required frequency exhibits show sustained use of its name, and the paired notched form remains legible at small size. Kidney is not proposed because organs are important or because an anatomy set should be completed; encoding it would not establish that every neighboring organ meets the same evidence.

D. Transient

Kidney is an established anatomical term rather than a campaign, event, or product. The embedded Google Books evidence spans 1500-2022, while current NIDDK, MedlinePlus, and HRSA guidance uses the same noun across testing, stones, dialysis, transplantation, and donation.

E. Faulty comparison

Existing organ emoji do not create an entitlement to Kidney. Lungs is used only as a small-size legibility comparison; the Kidney case rests on the named stone, testing, dialysis, transplant, and donation messages, the remaining ambiguity of Beans, the frequency evidence, and the paired notched pictograph.

Other Information

The singular name Kidney identifies the organ concept even though the example shows the familiar paired organs; this proposal does not request separate singular and plural characters. Vendors may vary color, shading, and fine anatomy while preserving two inward-facing notched forms, a visible offset, and a short central attachment. Full vascular anatomy is intentionally omitted for legibility at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>